

MBA CET 2026 After CAT 2025: Is It a Good Option? A Complete Guide for Aspirants

CAT 2025 is over, and for many aspirants, the big question now is: “What next?”

Whether your CAT attempt went well, average, or below expectations, the next major opportunity on the MBA entrance calendar is **MAH MBA CET 2026**, which is now **just 4 months away**.

In this blog, we break down **whether MBA CET 2026 is a good option after CAT**, who should consider it, exam structure differences, timelines, preparation strategy, and how to maximise your chances of making it to a top B-school in Maharashtra.

1 MBA CET vs CAT — Key Differences

Feature	CAT 2025	MBA CET 2026
Difficulty Level	High	Moderate
Style	Concept-heavy	Speed-heavy
Total Questions	66	200
Sections	VARC, LRDI, QA	LR, Abstract, QA, VARC
Time	120 mins	150 mins
Negative Marking	Yes	No
Competition	National-level	Maharashtra-heavy

Key Takeaways:

- CET is speed + accuracy driven, not concept-heavy.
- Logical Reasoning forms the largest part of CET.
- No negative marking → attempt more questions.
- CET is overall more scoring-friendly than CAT.

2. Important Dates for MBA CET 2026

- Registration Start: Last Week of December 2025
- Registration End: First Week Of March 2026
- Admit Card Release: Third week of March 2026
- CET Attempt 1: April 6th–8th, 2026
- CET Attempt 2: May 9th, 2026
- CAP Rounds: June–August 2026

Important Update:

MBA CET 2026 will have *two attempts* — giving students double the opportunity to score well.

3. Top Colleges Accepting MBA CET Scores

Flagship Colleges

- JBIMS Mumbai
- Sydenham (SIMSREE)
- Welingkar Institute (WE School)
- PUMBA Pune

Other Strong Colleges

- N. L. Dalmia
- MET
- SIES
- Chetana
- Xavier Institute (XIMR)
- Vivekanand (VSIT)
- IESMCRC
- CIMS
- Thakur Institute of Management

These colleges offer excellent placements and ROI, especially for Maharashtra quota students.

4. Why MBA CET 2026 Is a Good Option After CAT 2026

Another opportunity within 4 months-

CET gives you a chance to target top colleges **without losing time**.

Lower competition than CAT-

CAT has 2.5 lakh+ candidates, while CET has fewer → relatively lower competition.

Easier difficulty level-

Perfect for students who struggled with CAT's high-difficulty LRDI or QA.

Strong colleges through CET-

JBIMS, Sydenham, Welingkar, PUMBA, and many others.

Ideal for students with strong logic-

CET is heavy on LR, which benefits many CAT aspirants.

5. Who Should Definitely Consider MBA CET 2026?

- **Students whose CAT 2025 score won't get expected colleges**
CET gives a second chance without waiting a year.
- **Aspirants good at logic and puzzle**
CET rewards speed + accuracy in LR.
- **Students avoiding gap year**
CET fits perfectly into a continuous prep curve.
- **Maharashtra-based students**
Access to 80+ MMS colleges with low fees.

CAT may be the toughest exam — but it is **not the only gateway** to a great MBA college.

MBA CET 2026 is a smart, realistic, and accessible option for students seeking a second chance after CAT.

6. If you want to maximise your score...

MAH-CET is not a very hard nut to crack and if you have already appeared for CAT exam, it gets a little easier. Here are some tips for you to leverage your CAT preparation for the exam.

Need to change prep strategy when switching from CAT to CET

The blog emphasises that because MAH-CET differs from CAT in structure, difficulty, and focus, aspirants should “tweak” their preparation strategy — not treat CAT-prep and CET-prep as identical.

Why it's useful: This is exactly the message many aspirants need — helps justify why CET-specific focus matters even if they have CAT preparation background.

Familiarize with CET exam pattern thoroughly

Important details like CET's total duration (150 mins), sections (Logical/Abstract Reasoning, Quant, Verbal/RC), heavier weight for reasoning, no negative marking, and absence of sectional time-limit — all must be understood before you start preparing.

Why it's useful: This helps highlight to your readers that “pattern awareness + strategy adaptation” is key rather than just blindly reusing CAT tactics.

Focus strongly on Logical Reasoning & Abstract Reasoning

Since in CET, the Logical / Reasoning section carries very high weight (75 LR + 25 Abstract), 2IIM suggests aspirants practice a lot of LR questions, puzzles, and reasoning games (e.g. Sudoku, 2048) to build speed & accuracy.

Why it's useful: Emphasizing this helps your content stand out by giving aspirants a clear “focus area” to prioritise — which many CAT-only aspirants may neglect.

Speed matters — CET rewards speed + accuracy more than deep conceptual difficulty

Because CET is relatively easier per question but competition is high, aspirants need to ramp up speed and aim to attempt more questions — especially as there's no negative marking.

Why it's useful: This gives a tactical insight — good for aspirants who may have CAT-level conceptual prep but need to adapt to speed-based exam format for CET.

Don't chase overly difficult questions — align to CET level

2IIM warns that many CAT-level tough questions won't appear in CET, so spending time on extremely hard problems may be wasteful. Instead, aspirants should adapt to typical CET-level difficulty.

Why it's useful: This advice is valuable — many aspirants might unnecessarily over-prepare and burn out; this helps them focus on relevant content.

Consistent revision is important

Even if you are confident, consistent revision prevents forgetting. 2IIM says brains tend to forget a lot if you don't revise regularly; avoid leaving topics untouched for more than a few weeks.

Why it's useful: Helps enforce discipline and structure — useful for your readers who might be juggling CAT-to-CET transition alongside other commitments (studies/work).

Take CET-specific mocks early — from day one

Don't wait till the last minute. Start attempting full-length or sectional CET mocks that replicate actual CET pattern (time, sections, no negative marking). Treat mocks as real exam conditions and do detailed analysis afterwards.

Why it's useful: For many aspirants, this practical advice helps avoid surprises on exam day and builds exam temperament.

Plan and strategize your CET attempt (time allocation & section order)

Since CET doesn't have sectional time limits, aspirants must decide how to allocate time among sections, attempt order, and which type of questions to prioritise — strategy matters more than raw knowledge.

Why it's useful: This tactical insight helps aspirants maximise their CET score potential, and makes your blog more action-oriented than just informational.

Final Conclusion: Make the Most of the 2 Attempts of MBA CET 2026

For the first time, **MBA CET 2026 will offer TWO attempts** — an incredible advantage for students who want to maximise their chances.

If CAT 2025 didn't go as planned, these two CET attempts give you **double the chances** to secure admission in dream colleges like **JBIMS, Sydenham, Welingkar, PUMBA** and more.

With the right preparation, structured mocks, and a clear strategy — you can convert CET 2026 into your ticket to a top B-school.